

Flipping the Script

Looking on the Bright Side Through an Attitude of Gratitude

Main Scripture: Philippians 4:8

"Finally, brothers and sisters, whatever is true, whatever is noble, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think about such things."

Introduction (1-2 minutes)

Have you ever had one bad thing happen, and suddenly your whole day feels ruined?

Maybe you spill your coffee, fail a quiz, lose your phone, or someone says something hurtful. Before you know it, you're thinking:

- "Nothing ever goes right."
- "Today is the worst."
- "My life stinks."

It's amazing how quickly our minds can write a negative story.

Tonight I want to challenge you with this idea:

You may not be able to change your situation, but you can change the script you're telling yourself.

As followers of Jesus, God calls us to **flip the script**—not by pretending problems don't exist, but by choosing gratitude over grumbling and faith over fear.

Point 1: Your Focus Shapes Your Future

Paul wrote Philippians while sitting in prison.

Think about that.

He wasn't writing from a beach. He wasn't writing after winning the lottery. He wasn't writing from a comfortable home.

He was chained to a Roman guard.

Yet he tells believers:

"Whatever is excellent or praiseworthy—think about these things."

Paul teaches us something powerful:

Your mind is like a spotlight. Whatever you shine it on becomes the biggest thing in your life.

If you only focus on what's wrong... you'll always feel defeated.

If you intentionally focus on God's goodness... your perspective begins to change.

Notice Paul doesn't say: *"Ignore your problems."*

He says: *"Choose what deserves your attention."*

Point 2: Gratitude Flips the Script

Supporting Scripture:

1 Thessalonians 5:16–18

"Rejoice always, pray continually, give thanks in all circumstances..."

Notice it doesn't say:

"Give thanks **for** every circumstance."

It says:

"Give thanks **in** every circumstance."

There's a difference.

God isn't asking us to be thankful for pain.

He's asking us to remember He's still good while we're walking through it.

Gratitude changes our perspective.

Instead of saying: "I have to go to school..."

Try: "I get an education."

Instead of: "My parents are annoying..."

Maybe: "I'm thankful I have parents who care enough to set boundaries."

Instead of: "I don't have enough..."

Think: "God has already blessed me with more than I deserve."

Gratitude doesn't deny reality.

It changes how we view reality.

Point 3: Biblical Story — The Ten Lepers (Luke 17:11–19)

"11 Now it happened as He went to Jerusalem that He passed through the midst of Samaria and Galilee. 12 Then as He entered a certain village, there met Him ten men who were lepers, who stood afar off. 13 And they lifted up their voices and said, "Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!" 14 So when He saw them, He said to them, "Go, show yourselves to the priests." And so it was that as they went, they were cleansed. 15 And one of them, when he saw that he was healed, returned, and with a loud voice glorified God, 16 and fell down on his face at His feet, giving Him thanks. And he was a Samaritan. 17 So Jesus answered and said, "Were there not ten cleansed? But where are the nine? 18 Were there not any found who returned to give glory to God except this foreigner?" 19 And He said to him, "Arise, go your way. Your faith has made you well."

Imagine living with leprosy.

You lose your family. Your friends avoid you. You're considered unclean.

Ten men cried out:

"Jesus! Have mercy on us!"

Jesus healed every single one.

All ten received the miracle.

But only one came back.

Only one stopped long enough to say:

"Thank You."

Jesus asked:

"Weren't there ten?"

Only one had an attitude of gratitude.

Here's the amazing part:

The nine got healing.

The one who returned experienced relationship with Jesus.

Sometimes we're so busy asking God for the next blessing that we forget to thank Him for the last one.

Gratitude brings us closer to Jesus.

Point 4: Gratitude Changes Your Heart

Supporting Scripture:

Psalms 100:4

"Enter His gates with thanksgiving and His courts with praise..."

Did you notice?

Thanksgiving comes before praise.

Before we ask God for anything...

Before we complain...

We begin with gratitude.

Why?

Because grateful people recognize God is already working.

An ungrateful heart always focuses on what's missing.

A grateful heart notices what God has already done.

Application (2 minutes)

Here's a challenge.

For the next seven days...

Before you pick up your phone...

Before you check social media...

Write down **three things you're thankful for**.

Not the same three every day.

Three new ones.

Watch what happens.

Your circumstances might not change.

But your heart will.

Because gratitude rewires how we see life.

Closing

Life gives us plenty of reasons to complain.

The enemy wants us to believe:

- God isn't enough.
- Life isn't fair.
- You'll never be happy.

But Jesus invites us to flip the script.

Choose gratitude.

Choose hope.

Choose to focus on what God has done instead of what hasn't happened yet.

Remember Paul's words:

"Whatever is true... whatever is lovely... whatever is admirable... think about these things."

The more we focus on God's faithfulness, the more our faith grows.

An attitude of gratitude doesn't make every problem disappear—but it reminds us that God is bigger than every problem we'll ever face.

Closing Prayer

"Lord, thank You for all You've already done in our lives. Forgive us for the times we've focused more on what's missing than on Your faithfulness. Help us to flip the script—to replace complaining with gratitude, fear with faith, and negativity with hope. Teach us to see every day through the lens of Your goodness. May our grateful hearts point others to You. In Jesus' name, Amen."